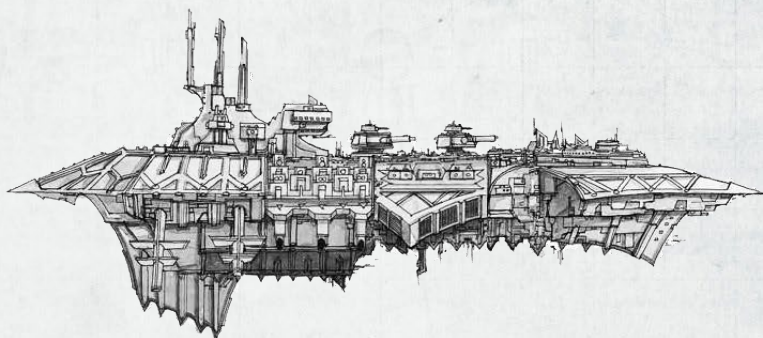


HECATE CLASS HEAVY CRUISER

Famous Ships: Blade of Fury, Erebus, Reign of Terror, Lustful



TYPE/HITS	SPEED	TURNS	SHIELDS	ARMOUR	TURRETS
Cruiser/8	25 cm	45°	2	5+	3
ARMAMENT		RANGE/SPEED		FIREPOWER/STR	FIRE ARC
Port launch bays		Swiftdeaths: 30 cm Doomfires: 20 cm Dreadclaws: 30 cm		2 squadrons	–
Starboard launch bays		Swiftdeaths: 30 cm Doomfires: 20 cm Dreadclaws: 30 cm		2 squadrons	–
Port weapons battery		45 cm		4	Left
Starboard weapons battery		45 cm		4	Right
Dorsal lance battery		60 cm		2	Left/front/right
Prow weapons battery		45 cm		6	Left/front/right

As the Styx began to fall out of favour late in M33, the Hecate was seen as a more fitting and well-rounded replacement for fleet engagements and solitary patrols. The shipyards at Cypra Mundi were only beginning to construct these in any quantity when newer hull designs by the shipyards of Mars were deemed more suitable for the Imperial Navy. Most were decommissioned by late M35, though the *Blade of Fury* was used in fleet exercises as part of the Gaerox Prerogative as late as M36. By this time a number of similar vessels had turned renegade, and fearing some inherent design flaw that made these ships susceptible to corruption, the Imperial Navy fleetlords at Cypra Mundi acted swiftly to decommission the remainder of these ships in favour of the new Mars-type hull design.

Only one of these vessels was known to have turned renegade before the Gothic War, though it is unknown with any certainty if it was present during that conflict. However, at least three of these ships were captured very early during Abaddon's 13th Black Crusade, including the *Blade of Fury*, *Erebus* and *Admiral Foster*. The *Blade of Fury* was subsequently seen accompanying the traitor battle barge *Wage of Sin* on several occasions, particularly during the razing of Belisimar and for several raids on the orbital docks of Belis Corona. The *Admiral Foster* was most active of the four. Renamed *Reign of Terror* by its captain, it participated in numerous engagements at Ormantep and Thracian Primaris and was among the fleet present at the destruction of Urthwart by the mighty Planet Killer.

FLEET LISTS

Chaos Incursion Fleet List (pg. 226), Black Crusade Fleet List (pg. 228), The Sorcerous Fleet (pg. 230), The Plaguefleet (pg. 232), The Berzerker Fleet (pg. 234), The Pleasurefleet (pg. 236)